

OPERATION AMBER CIRCUIT

SCENARIO TITLE: OPERATION AMBER CIRCUIT

DATE: 21 JUN 1982

DIRECTOR BRIEF:

A Warsaw Pact communications exercise in the Baltic coincides with a missing submarine contact, mobile radar activity, an aircraft incursion, and reports of an unauthorized command network. NATO must decide whether this is coup preparation, strategic deception, or a fragmented readiness drill.

OBJECTIVE:

Assess whether a rogue command group is attempting to create an independent launch capability. Recommend the safest action that tests the hypothesis while preserving NATO warning capacity.

HANDLING NOTE

This document contains fictional facts for a multi-agent training game. Each marked dossier is routed only to its named specialist. Facts should not be supplemented with outside knowledge.

[SUBMARINE DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] A Whiskey-class signals-intelligence submarine halted near an undersea communications junction used by Warsaw Pact naval units.
- [p. 2] NATO lost the contact after heavy merchant traffic entered the area; a second faint contact later moved east at commercial speed.
- [p. 2] The submarine carried no known ballistic missiles and had recently completed antenna repairs.
- [p. 2] Analysts disagree whether it was monitoring the junction, repairing a fault, or serving as a covert relay.
- You have no access to ELINT, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[ELINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] Three mobile air-defense radars activated in sequence without using the normal regional command preamble.
- [p. 2] One station transmitted an obsolete authentication burst last used eighteen months earlier.
- [p. 2] The activation chain ended before any weapons-guidance radar achieved a stable track.
- [p. 2] The pattern could indicate a backup command circuit, an exercise inject, operator error, or spoofing.
- You have no access to submarine, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[AIR DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] An East German transport aircraft crossed a restricted Polish training zone without the scheduled transponder code.
- [p. 3] It descended near a reserve command bunker, remained on the ground for eleven minutes, and returned by a different route.
- [p. 3] Photography shows cargo doors open but cannot identify passengers or equipment.
- [p. 3] Weather diversions were active elsewhere, but this airfield was reporting safe conditions.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or HUMINT reporting.

[HUMINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] A long-standing military source says several communications officers were abruptly reassigned to an unscheduled exercise cell.
- [p. 3] A frightened walk-in claims a general intends to demonstrate control of a regional launch network. The walk-in provides no documents and requests money.
- [p. 3] A monitored party official described the activity as an inspection ordered after repeated communications failures.
- [p. 3] The military source and party official are independent; the walk-in's access is unknown.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or aircraft reporting.

[END DOSSIER]

END OF FICTIONAL SCENARIO